

1. CHECK OUR RESOURCES (this guide is for long-term studying. If you're cramming, check out our cramming guide instead.)

Check our drives **properly**. Like **2-3 days** just going through everything

Not just open and close.

Actually go through:

- Official resources (syllabi, scheme of work, learner guides, etc)
- Books & Notes
- Lectures
- Extras (topicals, cheatsheets, flashcards, etc.)
- Links and Resources

Choose your PRIMARY and SECONDARY resources.

Get advice in Discord. Ask seniors. Ask everyone.

Download what *might* be useful later - don't trust memory.

Once you've shortlisted your resources → **Make a proper study timetable.**

2. PRINT OUT THE SYLLABUS.

Like actually print it, or at the very least, keep an annotated digital copy.

Syllabus/Specs tell you exactly:

- what to learn
- what types of questions will come
- what isn't asked

But don't let it cage you.

Syllabus ≠ Limit. Expand your understanding.

Some concepts only show up in past papers or as context questions.

3. FLASHCARDS = MEMORY

This utilises spaced repetition, which is scientifically proven to boost long-term retention by up to 200% and reduce study time by 30% (*Cepeda et al., 2006*).

- Sciences: equations, definitions
- Languages: vocabulary
- Dates, reforms, case studies

Even just **5 mins daily**. On the bus. Toilet.

Journey to/from school = UTILISE FLASHCARDS

We recommend digital flashcards - faster to make, easier to review, and way more time-efficient. (ANKI = goated)

Or physical if you like touching paper lol.

Making flashcards = **half the learning**

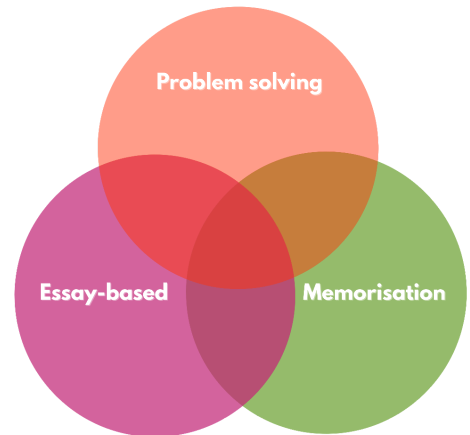
If you're short on time or panicking:

DON'T EVEN GO TOWARDS PHYSICAL CARDS, Make them digitally or use pre-made cards. Don't overthink.

4. BREAK DOWN YOUR SUBJECTS

Split subjects into 3 types:

1. **Memorisation-heavy** (e.g. Islamiyat, History, etc.)
 - Active recall (make notes)
 - Spaced repetition (revision/flashcards/cram)
2. **Problem solving** (e.g. Math)
 - Concept isn't enough. Practice questions.
 - Every topic = 15+ questions
3. **Essay-based** (e.g. English)
 - Write. Get feedback from teachers/students.
 - Apply the feedback.
 - Don't just read mark schemes, simulate them.



memorisation = make notes + flashcards
 problem solving = practice questions. short on time? do them with the mark scheme open. If you're stuck for more than 10 seconds, check the mark scheme.
 essay writing = practice questions + format + as much feedback as possible

Example: Sciences = both memorisation + problem solving and so on

5. DO PAST PAPERS RELIGIOUSLY

They might feel:

- Repetitive
- Annoying
- Boring

But guess what?

“Boring = Marks.”

You train your brain like a muscle.

Applying what you learn = more important than memorising.

Understand what examiners want > What you know, It sucks, but that's the system.

Student A knows 10x more but explains in his own way

Student B gives the examiner what they're looking for = **marks.**

80% OF MARKS WILL COME FROM 20% OF STUDYING

This is real.

Focus *more* on:

- High yield chapters
- Common Qs
- Examiner report trends
- What's ALWAYS asked

Don't try to do everything equally.

6. OPTIMISE YOURSELF

This is half the game.
No point knowing everything if your brain's mush.

Sleep:

Minimum = 6.5 hrs
Ideal = 8–10 hrs
You're not a zombie.

Exercise:

Walk. Stretch. Kick a ball even if for 10 mins. Don't rot.

Hydration:

Wake up → **chug water**

Diet:

Ideally, eat clean year-round - but **especially during exam season**. Cut the junk. Cut the **processed foods** (*anything that is not from God*). **Sugar crashes = low focus, Feeling shit leads to lower motivation.**

Socials/Entertainment:

Only give them up when needed, or when exams are around the corner.
Don't rot at your desk all day. Live life. *Live yours.*

7. USE GPT - BUT USE IT PROPERLY

It's a lifesaver - but only **if** you prompt it right.

- Feed it your **syllabus**, **mark scheme**, or even **your own notes**.
- Tell it your **subject**, **topic**, and what exactly you're struggling with.
- Be **specific** with your prompts. Vague in = vague out.
- Use it to test yourself, simplify tough concepts, or get explanations in plain English.
- Don't let it think for you. Let it **guide**, not replace, your effort.

8. FINAL ADVICE:

GET USED TO DOING QUESTIONS.

Don't spend the whole year just "studying" passively.
Watching lectures ≠ Studying
Reading notes ≠ Studying

You must **apply** what you've learned.

Doing Qs = Studying.

You're not just here to learn.
You're here to **score**.

BASIC ADVICE

- **Minimize distractions.** Put your phone on **silent** or **toss it across the room** if you have to.
- Use the **Pomodoro Technique**: 25 mins focus → 5 min break.
- Keep your desk **clean**. Cluttered space = cluttered mind.
- Set **1-2 daily goals**. That's enough to build momentum.
- Use a **planner or to-do list**. **Visually seeing your progress = less stress**.
- Keep **water + snacks nearby**. Don't get up for dumb reasons.
- Try **lofi or ambient music**. Might help you focus. Try and see.

This guide isn't the answer - you are. No one's tracking your progress but you.
Be honest. Be consistent. You'll thank yourself in a few months.
And yeah we're here when you need us.

our links.

[our website](#)

[discord](#)

[instagram](#)

[youtube](#)

[reddit](#)